

Current Affairs Notes

Class Date: 26 September 2026 | Topics: International Relations, Summits, Defence Exercises, Organisations, Awards & Places in News

1. Busan Agreement (India note: China–USA Trade Truce)

Background: In 2025, US President Donald Trump launched a global **tariff war**, threatening steep tariffs (e.g. on India, and on countries trading with Russia).

China was most affected; a meeting was held in **Busan, South Korea** (2025) between Trump and Chinese President **Xi Jinping**.

US agreed to keep China out of the tariff war; in return, China agreed to control production of the drug **Fentanyl**, which the US said China was supplying.

This understanding is called the **Busan Agreement** (effective from November 2025).

Latest: The Busan Agreement has now been **extended till January 2027**.

China–USA trade profile: China – rare earth metals, EVs, electronics manufacturing hub. USA – semiconductors, manufacturing units.

Tariff = additional tax on imported goods.

China geography recap: Capital – **Beijing**; cities – Shanghai; rivers – Yangtze, Yellow (Huang He), Wanghu; deserts – Taklamakan, Gobi.

USA/North America recap: FIFA World Cup 2026 co-hosts – **USA, Canada, Mexico**; **Alaska** – site of the Trump–Putin (Russia) meeting.

2. Key Declarations & Agreements

New Delhi Declaration – linked to the **BRICS** summit hosted by India; signed at **Bharat Mandapam**, New Delhi, with participation of multiple countries.

CETA (Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement) – between **India and the UK**.

100 Days Partnership Declaration – completed recently (Sept 2026) between **Canada and Ukraine**.

Delhi Declaration – issued by the **WHO**, focused on South Asian countries' health cooperation.

3. Defence Exercises — India with Partner Countries

Exercise	Partner Country	Force/Type
Varuna	France	Naval
Garuda	France	Air Force
Shakti	France	Army
Indira	Russia	Bilateral
Dharma Guardian	Japan	Army
Vajra Prahar	USA	Special Forces
Yudh Abhyas	USA	Army
Pasex	Egypt (Mediterranean Sea)	Naval

INS Trishul (Talwar-class, built by Russia) took part in the **Pasex exercise** with Egypt in the Mediterranean Sea, then joined **Varuna (24th edition)** with France at **Toulon Port**, France (French overseas territories/islands lie in the Mediterranean).

Strait of Gibraltar: connects the Atlantic Ocean with the Mediterranean Sea; separates **Morocco** from **Spain**.

4. FIPIC Summit (2nd Foreign Ministers' Meeting)

FIPIC = **Forum for India–Pacific Islands Cooperation** (India + Indian Ocean/Pacific island nations).

Held on the sidelines of the **81st UN General Assembly session, New York** (on the Hudson River), 24 September 2026; UNGA President from **Bangladesh**.

India represented by External Affairs Minister **Dr S. Jaishankar**.

Edition	Year	Venue
1st	2014	Suva, Fiji
2nd	2015	Jaipur, India
3rd	2023	Port Moresby, Papua New Guinea
4th	2026	New York, USA

5. ASEAN, East Asia Summit & Regional Groupings

East Asia Summit (EAS): 14th edition held in the **Philippines** (22–24 September 2026); focus – trade, economy, investment; first edition held in 2005; India represented by **Nitin Kumar Yadav** (Department of Economic Affairs).

ASEAN Summit: 48th edition, hosted by the **Philippines**; India is **not** a member, only a **Dialogue Partner** (since 1992).

India–ASEAN Summit: 23rd edition, held in **Manila** (Luzon Island; also home to the **ADB Bank HQ**).

ASEAN also known as the **Bangkok Declaration**; motto — “One Vision, One Identity, One Community”; India–ASEAN trade pact: **AITGA**, signed in **2010**.

India signed **BrahMos missile** deals with the **Philippines** and **Vietnam**.

Grouping	Members	Headquarters
ASEAN	11	Jakarta, Indonesia
SAARC	8	Kathmandu, Nepal
BIMSTEC	7	Dhaka, Bangladesh

6. Other Organisations & Blocs in the News

SCO – 15th SCO & Dialogue Partnership 2026: **Laos** added as a Dialogue Partner.

NDB (BRICS) Bank – 10th member added (June 2026): **Uzbekistan**.

Permanent Court of Arbitration (PCA) – **Indonesia** became its **127th member** (PCA is linked to the Indus Waters Treaty dispute).

BRICS: 18th Summit hosted by **India** in New Delhi at Bharat Mandapam; total members = 11 (newest – **Indonesia**); partner countries = 10 (newest – **Vietnam**); total 21 countries. Related summits held across India — Culture (Varanasi), Education & Women Empowerment (Kerala), Space (Bengaluru). Next year's (2027) BRICS Summit to be hosted by **China**.

7. International Organisation Headquarters

Organisation	Headquarters
IAEA (International Atomic Energy Agency)	Vienna, Austria
FAO (Food and Agriculture Organization)	Rome, Italy
IMO (International Maritime Organization)	London, UK
G20 Summit 2026 (venue)	Miami, USA
ASEAN Chairperson 2026	Philippines

8. Places in News — Lonely Planet “Best in Travel 2027”

Report: **Lonely Planet**, “Best in Travel 2027” list — identifies top travel destinations for the coming year. Two Indian destinations feature in the Top 50: **Darjeeling** and **Gujarat**.

Darjeeling: known for Kanchenjunga view (Sikkim side) and tea plantations (linked to Assam tea belt); added to UNESCO list in **1999**; famous for the Darjeeling Toy Train and Darjeeling Tea (India's first **GI tag**, awarded 2004–05).

Gujarat: Rann of Kutch (White Desert — due to high salt content), Somnath Temple, Statue of Unity, Asiatic Lions, Bannni Grassland. India's total UNESCO World Heritage Sites: **45**; latest addition — **Sarnath, Uttar Pradesh** (dedicated to Buddhism).

UNESCO-listed mountains of India: Darjeeling (1999), Nilgiri (2005), Kalka–Shimla Railway (2008).

Gujarat's other UNESCO sites: Champaner-Pavagadh, Rani ki Vav, Historic City of Ahmedabad, Dholavira.

Match the Following — UNESCO/Heritage Sites & States

Site	State
Kaziranga	Assam
Dholavira	Gujarat
Khajuraho	Madhya Pradesh
Hampi	Karnataka

9. BRICS Theatre/Film Festival 2026

Venue: **New Delhi** (National School of Drama, est. 1959); Duration: 3 days, **12–14 October 2026**; Organised by the **Ministry of Culture**. Theme: “Shared Stories, Shared Future” (BRICS overall theme: Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability); over 100 participants expected.

10. Indian Films — Oscars 2027 (International Feature Category)

Two Indian films have entered/been recognised in the Best International Feature category: one film from **Nagaland** (also awarded at the **Toronto** festival, Canada) and one from **Maharashtra**.

11. Kalpsar Project (India–Netherlands MoU)

MoU signed with the **Netherlands** (capital: Amsterdam) after PM Modi's visit there in **May 2026**, where he admired a Dutch sea-dam structure.

Project: **Kalpsar Project**, in the **Gulf of Khambhat, Gujarat** — a sea dam (initially ~**30 km**) to be built jointly with the Netherlands, using “**Two-Depth**” technology; designed to be multipurpose.

Rivers to be connected/regulated: **Sabarmati, Mahi, and Narmada**.

12. FAO Award — Mizoram

Award given to **Zoliani Thangi** (local name: “**Pi Mary**”) of **Mizoram** for her contribution to strawberry cultivation (farming since 2024, strong output by 2025).

FAO = Food and Agriculture Organization, founded **16 October 1945**, HQ Rome, Italy; earlier, PM Modi received FAO's **Agricola Medal** in Italy.

2026 theme: dedicated to **Women Farmers**; award (“Hero Award”) to be given to 100 women farmers in **October 2026**.

Mizoram facts: statehood along with Arunachal Pradesh (1987); capital — Aizawl; Lushai tribe; Blue Mountain / Phawngpui.

Quick Revision Table

Topic	Key Fact
Busan Agreement	USA–China truce; extended till Jan 2027
FIPIC 4th Summit	New York, 24 Sept 2026; India – S. Jaishankar
East Asia Summit	14th edition, Philippines; India – Nitin Kumar Yadav
ASEAN Summit	48th edition, Philippines; India = Dialogue Partner (1992)
India–ASEAN Summit	23rd edition, Manila
AITGA	India–ASEAN trade pact, signed 2010
Varuna Exercise	India–France (Naval), 24th ed., Toulon Port
NDB 10th member	Uzbekistan (June 2026)
PCA 127th member	Indonesia
SCO new Dialogue Partner	Laos
BRICS Theatre Festival	New Delhi, 12–14 Oct 2026
Kalpsar Project	Gulf of Khambhat, Gujarat, with Netherlands
FAO Award (Mizoram)	Zoliani Thangi ("Pi Mary") – strawberry farming
Lonely Planet 2027	Darjeeling & Gujarat (India)
India UNESCO sites	45 total; latest – Sarnath, UP
G20 2026 host city	Miami, USA

Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs)

Q1. The Busan Agreement between the USA and China has recently been extended till which date? (a) December 2026 (b) January 2027 (c) November 2027 (d) March 2027 Answer: (b) January 2027	Q2. The 2nd FIPIC Foreign Ministers' Meeting was recently held in which city? (a) Suva (b) Jaipur (c) New York (d) Port Moresby Answer: (c) New York
Q3. Who represented India at the 2nd FIPIC Foreign Ministers' Meeting? (a) Rajnath Singh (b) Dr S. Jaishankar (c) Nirmala Sitharaman (d) Piyush Goyal Answer: (b) Dr S. Jaishankar	Q4. The 14th East Asia Summit (2026) was hosted by which country? (a) Indonesia (b) Philippines (c) Thailand (d) Vietnam Answer: (b) Philippines
Q5. India is related to ASEAN as a: (a) Full member (b) Observer (c) Dialogue Partner (d) Founding member Answer: (c) Dialogue Partner	Q6. AITGA (India–ASEAN trade agreement) was signed in which year? (a) 2005 (b) 2010 (c) 2014 (d) 2018 Answer: (b) 2010
Q7. The Varuna naval exercise (24th edition) held recently at Toulon Port is conducted between India and: (a) France (b) Russia (c) Japan (d) USA Answer: (a) France	Q8. Which country recently became the 10th member of the New Development Bank (NDB)? (a) Uzbekistan (b) Indonesia (c) Vietnam (d) Laos Answer: (a) Uzbekistan
Q9. Indonesia recently became the 127th member of which body, linked to the Indus Waters Treaty dispute? (a) International Court of Justice (b) Permanent Court of Arbitration (c) UN Security Council (d) WTO Answer: (b) Permanent Court of Arbitration	Q10. The BRICS Theatre/Film Festival 2026 will be hosted in which city? (a) Mumbai (b) Varanasi (c) New Delhi (d) Bengaluru Answer: (c) New Delhi
Q11. The Kalpsar Project, developed with Dutch (Netherlands) assistance, is located in the Gulf of Khambhat in: (a) Maharashtra (b) Gujarat (c) Kerala (d) Odisha Answer: (b) Gujarat	Q12. The FAO award for strawberry farming was recently given to a woman farmer from which state? (a) Nagaland (b) Manipur (c) Mizoram (d) Meghalaya Answer: (c) Mizoram
Q13. Which two Indian destinations were featured in Lonely Planet's 'Best in Travel 2027' Top 50 list? (a) Goa and Kerala (b) Darjeeling and Gujarat (c) Ladakh and Rajasthan (d) Manali and Sikkim Answer: (b) Darjeeling and Gujarat	Q14. What is India's total number of UNESCO World Heritage Sites (as per the latest addition, Sarnath)? (a) 42 (b) 43 (c) 44 (d) 45 Answer: (d) 45
Q15. The G20 Summit 2026 is scheduled to be held in which city? (a) Rome (b) Miami (c) Rio de Janeiro (d) Johannesburg Answer: (b) Miami	Q16. Which country was recently added as a new BRICS member, taking the total to 11 members? (a) Vietnam (b) Indonesia (c) Uzbekistan (d) Nigeria Answer: (b) Indonesia
Q17. The headquarters of the Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO) is located in: (a) Geneva (b) Vienna (c) Rome (d) Paris Answer: (c) Rome	Q18. The India–ASEAN Summit (23rd edition) was held in which city? (a) Jakarta (b) Manila (c) Bangkok (d) Hanoi Answer: (b) Manila